

SmartNote AI · User Guide

Your Supernote in the age of AI, privacy first.

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SOURCES & ISSUES

github.com/AgP42/SN-Plugin-SmartNoteAI

SUPPORT

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1 Welcome to SmartNote AI

Your Supernote in the age of AI, privacy first.

START HERE · 3 STEPS

1

Paste your key

Create a Mistral API key at **admin.mistral.ai**, then paste it once into *Plugin configuration* → 1 · API key. That's the only prerequisite.

2

Write, lasso & ask

Lasso a zone or open the floating assistant over any page and ask AI about this context.

3

Unlock the full plugin

To unlock its full capacity, transcribe the notebooks you choose; then you can search every word, export the transcript, and give your documents to AI agents.

WHAT YOU CAN DO, RIGHT AWAY

Ask about the page you are writing

The floating assistant sits over your note; you keep writing while it answers. Nothing has to be prepared, transcribed or stored first.

Lasso and ask

Circle a scribbled address, a diagram, a table. "What's the postcode?" · "Explain this." · "Turn this into a checklist."

A searchable library

Transcribe what you choose. Then search every word you ever wrote, in seconds.

Give an assistant your documents

An agent that knows your project notebooks; another that knows a 300-page PDF and quotes it.

Get your text out

Export any page, notebook or folder to .md or .txt, straight into your Supernote file browser.

Ask the web, with sources

Arm web search for a single message; the answer comes back citing where it found each fact.

PRIVACY IS NOT A FEATURE, IT IS THE FOUNDATION

Our Supernotes carry personal content: our daily life, our thinking, our professional notes. Caring about privacy was my main concern while building this plugin. That is why I chose to offer **Mistral AI as the only AI provider**: it is the most capable AI provider that falls under European GDPR protection law. See **chapter 6** for the full reasoning behind this choice and what it means for you.

2 Core concepts

A few core ideas explain the whole plugin.

Transcripts: how a page becomes text

A page of handwriting is an image. To search it, quote it, or discuss it, it has to become text. That is what **READ** does, and every page goes through the same two steps:

STEP 1 · OCR

Mistral OCR 4 reads the page

Fast, cheap and powerful. It returns the text plus a confidence score for each word, but it doesn't "see" drawings, schemas or handwritten notes on a PDF, and takes no instructions.

STEP 2 · VISION

Ministral 14B reads the image

With the OCR text riding along as a hint. Vision understands layout, tables, drawings, margin notes and your own conventions, and it follows the prompt you can edit (§3.3).

Each result is stored on the tablet with a fingerprint of the page. This allows every change to be easily identified and only modified pages are re-read. The fingerprint follows the content, not the location: **move or copy a note or PDF to another folder, or move or copy a page between two notes, and its transcript is found again, never re-charged. A move takes everything with it, the file's sync mode, the agents that know it, and any lock you set. Renaming a PDF, however, counts as a new document: it is re-read once.**

Handwritten annotations on a PDF are captured: annotated pages get a Vision read with your ink composited, and are re-checked automatically when you write on them again.

Page after page, those transcripts become a **library**: your own local, searchable copy of what you wrote. It powers **Search** (one query across every notebook, in seconds) and **Export**. Nothing is uploaded to build it, it lives in the plugin's private storage, on the device only.

One AI provider, by choice: Mistral

SmartNote AI talks to exactly one provider, **Mistral AI**, a European company under the GDPR. That is a deliberate, privacy-first decision, not a limitation: your notes stay under European law, and on a paid plan Mistral never trains on your data. The full reasoning, and what it means if you write from outside the EU, is in §6.2.

FREE TIER

Every feature works on the free tier, with comfortable limits: all models are available, and field-testing in July 2026 gave roughly **~1300 transcribed pages / month** plus a lot of chat before reaching the limits. Only a **paid plan** guarantees Mistral never trains on your data.

Mistral currently offer 10€/months of API usage to anyone subscribing to Pay-as-you-go. Check Mistral billing rules. With 10€ budget you can transcribe ~3000 pages.

Chat and agents

Once a page has a transcript (or on demand, live), you can chat about it. The floating assistant is a movable panel that sits over your note. It always knows what you are looking at, and you can add anything else: other pages, whole notebooks, a lassoed image.

An **agent** is the same chat with a memory of its own: a name, a persona, a model, and a set of library documents it always knows. Four ready-made agents ship with the plugin and can be added in one tap:

Extractor: actions, dates, figures

Writer: notes into clean prose

Tutor: explains & quizzes you

Brainstorm: pushes ideas further

They are ordinary agents once added: rename them, change their model, give them documents. And you create your own, a “Meeting notes” agent over your work notebooks, a “Recipes” agent, a “Thesis” agent that knows a long PDF and quotes it. You pick one when you start a conversation.

The menu: one button, everything behind it

The Supernote toolbar entry **SmartNote AI Menu** opens a compact menu over your page.

ENTRY	WHAT IT OPENS
Open the assistant	the floating chat, on the current page
Library: Sync, Search & Export	the library and the sync cockpit
Current note transcript	the note / PDF you have open
Current page transcript	the exact page you are on
Plugin configuration	the three configuration doors
User manual (PDF)	this guide

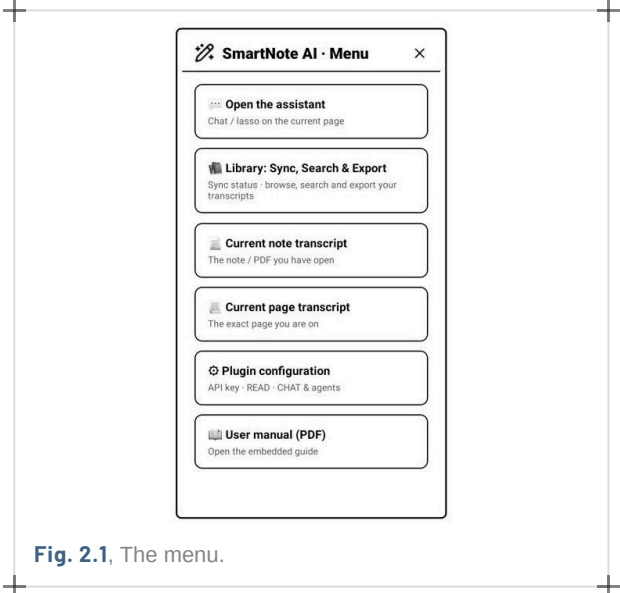
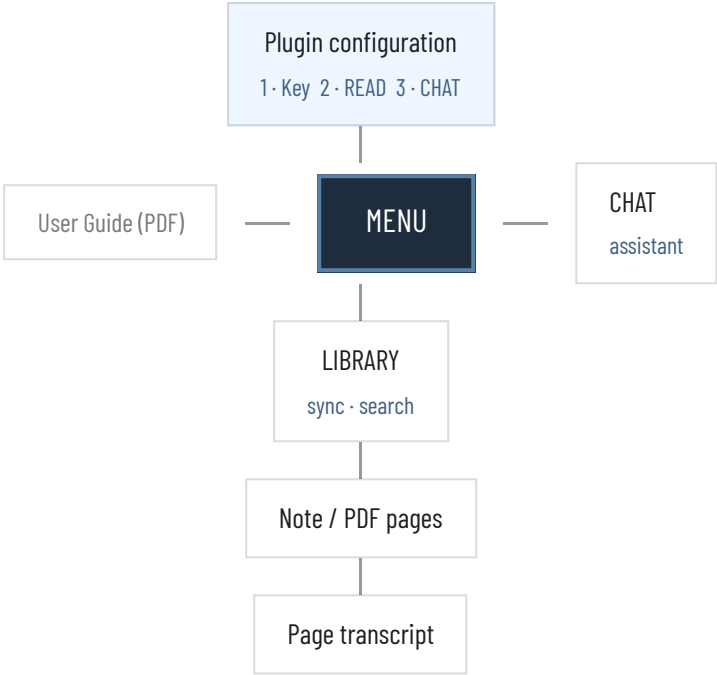


Fig. 2.1, The menu.

Map of the plugin



Every screen reaches the Menu from its top bar. Going down goes deeper; going up comes back. The User Guide is a one-way trip, it opens in the Supernote reader and the plugin steps aside.

3 Configuration

Three doors, reached from **Plugin configuration**. Nothing here is a prerequisite: the plugin works out of the box once the Mistral API key is in.

3.1 · Getting started: your Mistral API key

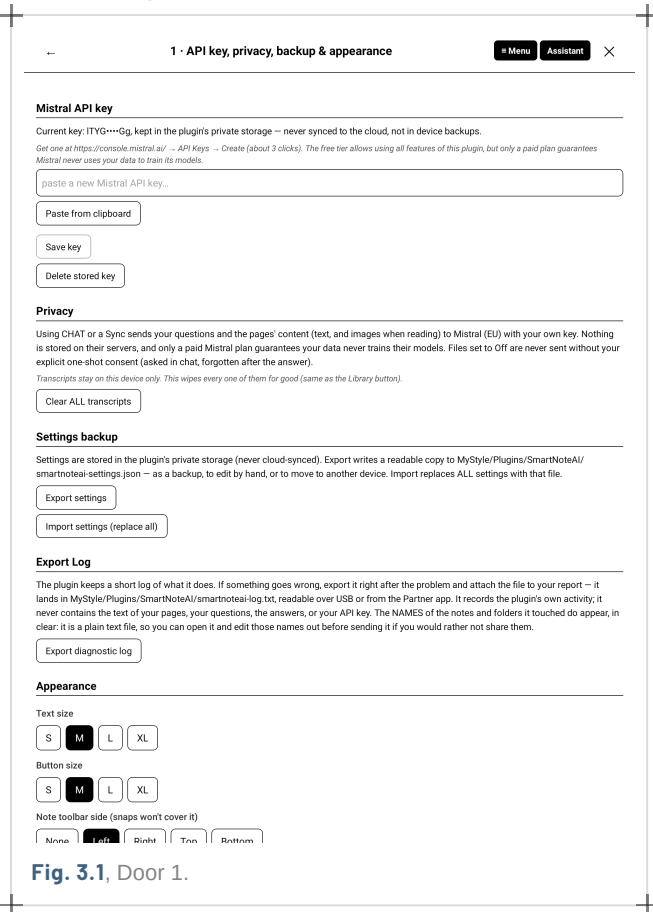
SmartNote AI has no server of its own and no subscription. You create a key at Mistral, paste it once, and pay Mistral directly for what you use.

- 1 Create an account**
at `admin.mistral.ai`.
- 2 Land on Mistral Studio**
Everything you need is in the left rail.
- 3 Open *My API Keys***
via your account menu, bottom left. Choose *Create new key*.
- 4 Name the key**
e.g. “SmartNote Plugin”, so it's easy to revoke later. Expiration and workspace can stay on defaults.
- 5 Copy the key**
It is shown once. Copy it now.
- 6 It is listed**
and can be revoked at any time from the same screen.

7 Paste it into the plugin

Plugin configuration → **1 · API key** → *Paste from clipboard* → *Save key*.

3.2 · Configuration Door 1: API key, privacy, backup & appearance



Mistral API key. Shows the current key masked. *Paste from clipboard* fills the field (the Supernote keyboard has no paste); *Save key* stores it in the plugin's private directory, never in a cloud-synced folder. *Delete stored key* removes it.

Privacy. Reminds you what leaves the device: your questions and the content of the pages you send. *Clear ALL transcripts* wipes the local library in one go.

Settings backup. Settings live in private storage and are never synced. *Export settings* and *Import settings* sit side by side: the first writes a readable copy to `MyStyle/Plugins/SmartNoteAI/`, the second replaces all settings with that file.

Export Log. The plugin keeps a short log of what it does. If something goes wrong, export it right after the problem: *Export diagnostic log* writes `MyStyle/Plugins/SmartNoteAI/smartnoteai-log.txt`, which you can copy over USB or from the Partner app and attach to a bug report at github.com/AgP42/SN-Plugin-SmartNoteAI/issues. The file already carries the plugin version, your device model, the Android build and a summary of your library, so there is nothing else to look up. It records the plugin's own activity only, never the text of your pages, your questions, the AI's answers, or your API key. The **names** of the notes and folders it touched do appear in clear, it is a plain text file, so you can open it and edit those names out before sending if you would rather not share them. A crash writes the log by itself, with the error, before the plugin goes down, so exporting after a restart still shows what happened.

Appearance. Text size (S/M/L/XL) and Button size apply everywhere, floating panel included, set these first if the UI feels small. *Note toolbar side* tells the plugin where your pen toolbar sits, so panels never cover it.

3.3 · Configuration Door 2: READ: AI transcript params

This door shapes what the AI is told when it reads a page. It drives the **Vision** step.

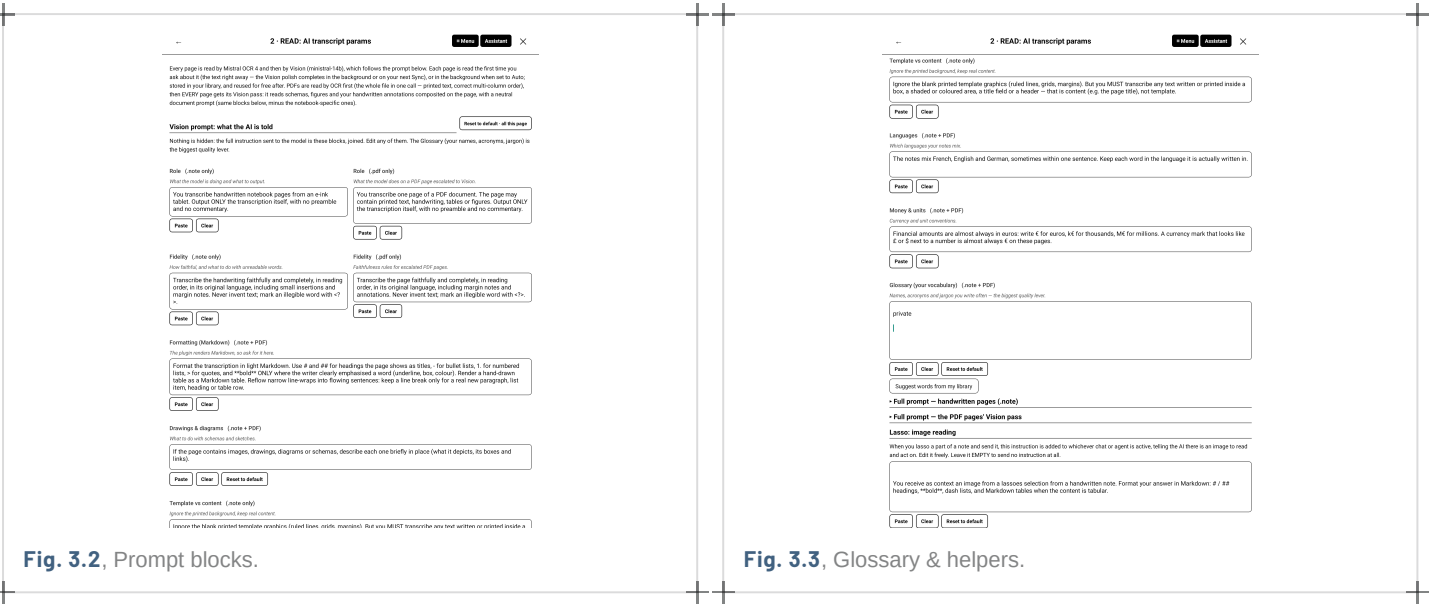


Fig. 3.2, Prompt blocks.

Fig. 3.3, Glossary & helpers.

The prompt is not hidden: it is a list of editable blocks, joined into the instruction actually sent. The shipped blocks are a tested, high-performing base, but they are tuned to *my* notes: **to get good results on yours, you must adapt them to your own context**, the language(s) you write in, your names, acronyms and jargon (the Glossary), your financial and unit conventions, and how you use drawings and templates. Every block has a *Reset*, plus a *Reset to default, all this page* at the top, so you can experiment freely.

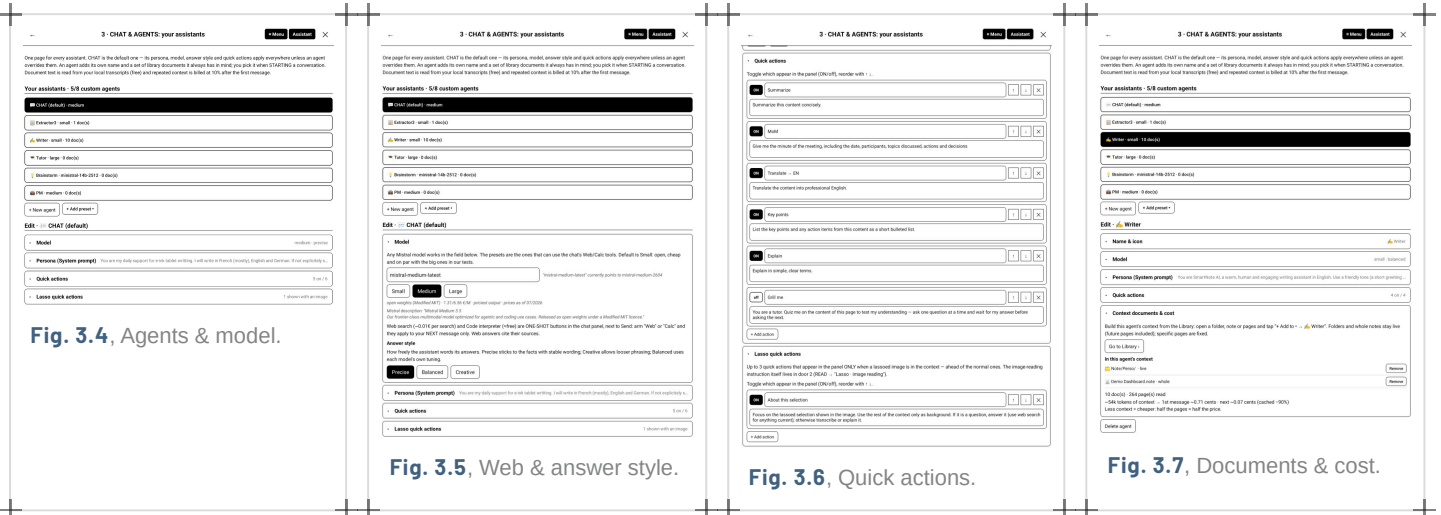
BLOCK	WHAT IT CONTROLS
Role (.note / .pdf)	what the model is doing, transcribe a handwritten page, or a document page. Two variants, because a PDF is not a notebook.
Fidelity	how faithful to be, and what to do with unreadable words (mark them <?> rather than invent).
Formatting (Markdown)	headings, lists, tables, how to reflow wrapped lines into real paragraphs. The plugin renders Markdown everywhere.
Drawings & diagrams	what to do with a sketch or schema: describe it briefly, in place.
Template vs content	ignore the printed template (ruled lines, grids, margins) but keep anything written inside a box or header.
Languages	which languages your notes mix. Keep each word in the language it was written in.
Money & units	currency and unit conventions (a bare £/\$ next to a number is usually your currency).
Glossary (your vocabulary)	The single biggest quality lever: your names, acronyms and jargon.

Three helpers sit under the glossary: **Suggest words from my library** mines what has already been read for frequent and low-confidence words; **Test the prompt on the current page** runs a real read so you can judge a change before applying it; **Full prompt** unfolds the exact text that will be sent. At the bottom, **Lasso: image reading** is the instruction

sent with a lassoed image (leave empty to send none). The assistant's model must be able to see images, Minstral, Mistral Small, Medium and Large all can.

3.4 · Configuration Door 3: CHAT & AGENTS: your assistants

One page for every assistant. **CHAT** is the default; its persona, model, answer style and quick actions apply everywhere unless an agent overrides them. Up to 8 custom agents plus CHAT (9 entries in all).



Model. Any Mistral model name works; presets are the ones that can use the chat's Web and have Vision capability (needed for the Lasso feature). Each preset points to -latest, so a new Mistral model is used automatically when available. The screen shows each model's real price and description, so pick from what it displays rather than a fixed ranking, prices and capabilities change.

Web search is one-shot: you arm it in the chat panel (button labeled **Web (non-EU)**) and it applies to your next message only. Web answers cite their sources (~0.01 € per search). This is the plugin's one non-EU request (see Privacy): Mistral does not offer web search on EU inference.

Answer style. Precise sticks to the facts, Creative allows looser phrasing, Balanced is the model's own tuning.

Persona (system prompt). Who the assistant is and how it talks to you, prepended to every conversation.

Quick actions are the one-tap prompts under the chat input. Toggle, reorder, edit or add your own; they write into the input field so you can adapt before sending. **Lasso quick actions** (up to 3) appear only while a lassoed image is in context.

+ Add preset. Adds a ready-made agent to the list, the quickest way to start; edit it from there or build your own from scratch.

Context documents & cost. Build an agent's context from the Library. Folders and whole notes stay live (future pages included automatically); specific pages are fixed. The screen tells you how many pages are already read, what reading the rest would cost, and the token weight, less context is cheaper. Within a conversation only the first message pays the full context; caching then bills the rest at about 10%.

4 Library

The Library is your local transcript store and the cockpit for syncing, searching and exporting. The tree shows your Note and Document folders, SD card included. Each row carries its sync chip, its page count, how many pages are still to read, and a badge for every agent that knows it.

Whole-library actions live at the top: *Export all* (.md / .txt), *Back up library / Restore backup*, *Clear all transcripts*, and *Clear transcripts of Off notes* (when a note was in Auto or Manual and already transcribed, then switched to Off, its existing transcript is kept, this button deletes those on request).

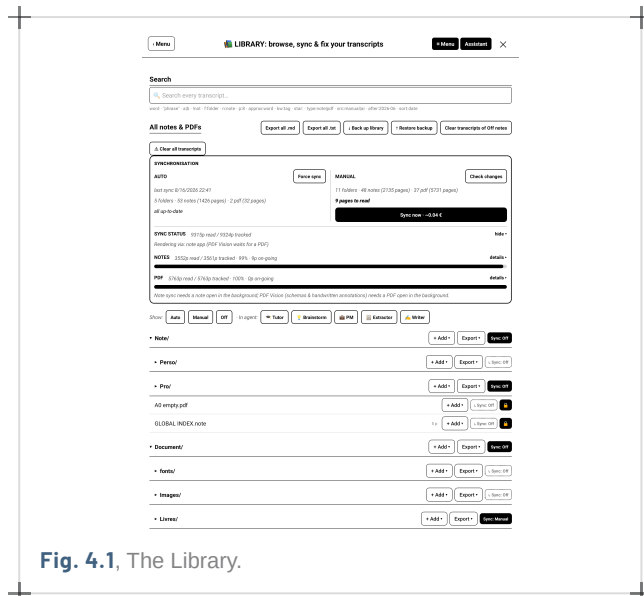


Fig. 4.1, The Library.

4.1 Synchronisation

Every folder and note carries a **mode chip**, set with one tap. Setting a chip costs nothing, it only saves a preference. A folder's mode covers everything under it; a single document can override its folder. A row that follows its parent shows an inherited chip, **Sync: X** (the mode it takes from above); tapping cycles **Off** → **Manual** → **Auto** → **inherit** when a parent folder is tracked, so you can always fall back to the folder's choice.

Off - the privacy switch

Never sent to the AI. Asking about an Off page needs an explicit one-time consent, and that read is not stored. Existing transcripts stay searchable until you clear them.

Manual

Read only when you ask, a *Sync* button, or a chat question that needs the page. "Sync now" reads what it can in one pass; if a backlog is left, the counts show it, tap *Sync now* again. Pending Vision passes still finish on their own.

Auto

Changes are read in the background, page by page, **while the plugin is running.**

A good habit: active notebooks on Auto, archives on Manual, anything private on Off.

Notes and PDFs have different constraints

A page is rendered by the app that owns it: note pages need the note app in the background; PDF Vision needs the document reader.

The **OCR step of a PDF is the exception**, it reads the file's bytes whatever is on screen. The plugin probes what it can render at every pass (*Rendering via: note app / PDF reader / none yet*). If PDF Vision pages wait and rendering fails, a ► **Resume PDF Vision** button appears, you decide when to tap it; the plugin never opens a document by itself.

HONEST LIMITS

- Auto works while the plugin lives. Close everything and it pauses, then resumes where it stopped.
- In the background, how long the system keeps it running is out of the plugin's hands.
- Nothing runs while the device is off.
- A page takes roughly 8-30 s (render + OCR + Vision). A first full-notebook sync is a “start it and let it run” job.
- Unsupervised, Auto reads at most **500 pages per session**; actions you ask for yourself (Sync now, Force sync, Force Vision) have no such cap.

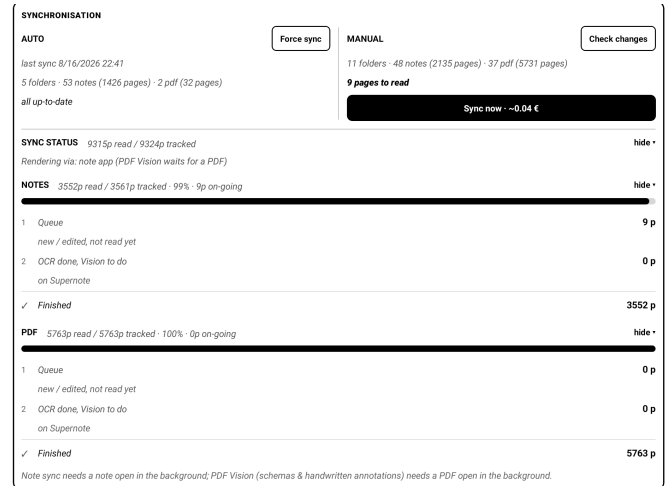


Fig. 4.2, The Synchronisation frame.

BACKGROUND SYNC, SAFEGUARDS

- **Cleared pages repair safely.** If you clear one page of an already-read PDF, it shows as pending again and is re-read on your next explicit Sync (or Library action) with that PDF open in the reader. Background passes never guess.
- **Wrong-image protection.** A Vision result that doesn't match the page it was asked about (a rare renderer mix-up) is rejected instead of stored; the page keeps its safe OCR text. To force a fresh read: open that PDF and use *Redo AI* on the page.
- **Self-cleaning counts.** Deleting a file on the device makes its leftover “to read” count disappear by itself after a few background passes, no manual cleanup. A note you deleted disappears from the Library on its own: once the plugin has proof the file is really gone (a minute or so), its transcript is removed, from storage too, not just from the list.
- **Moving vs renaming.** Moving or copying a PDF (same file name) keeps its transcripts for free. Renaming it counts as a new document: it is re-read once.

4.2 · Browse transcripts

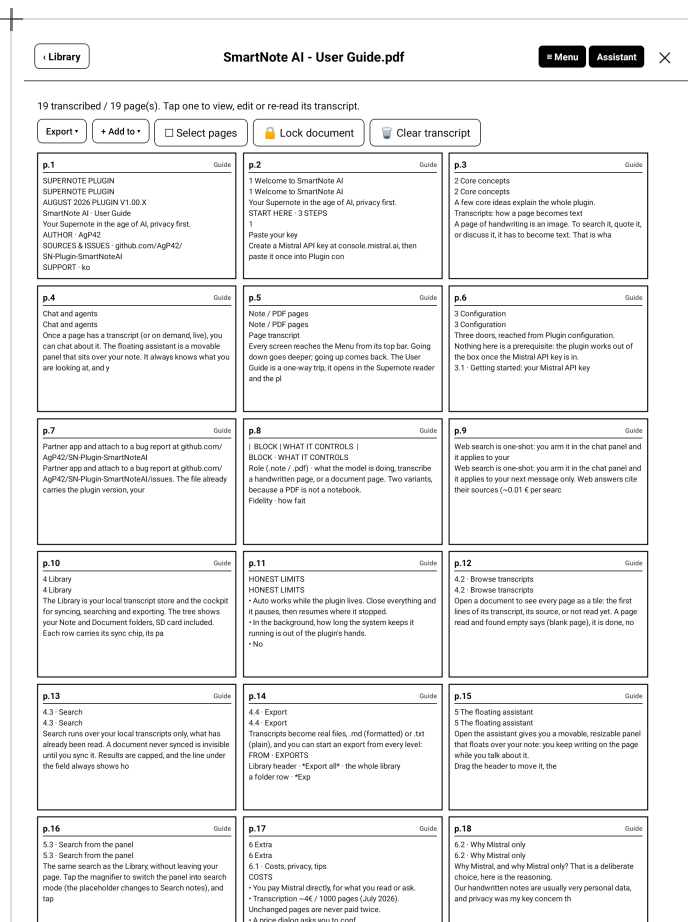


Fig. 4.3, Pages as tiles.

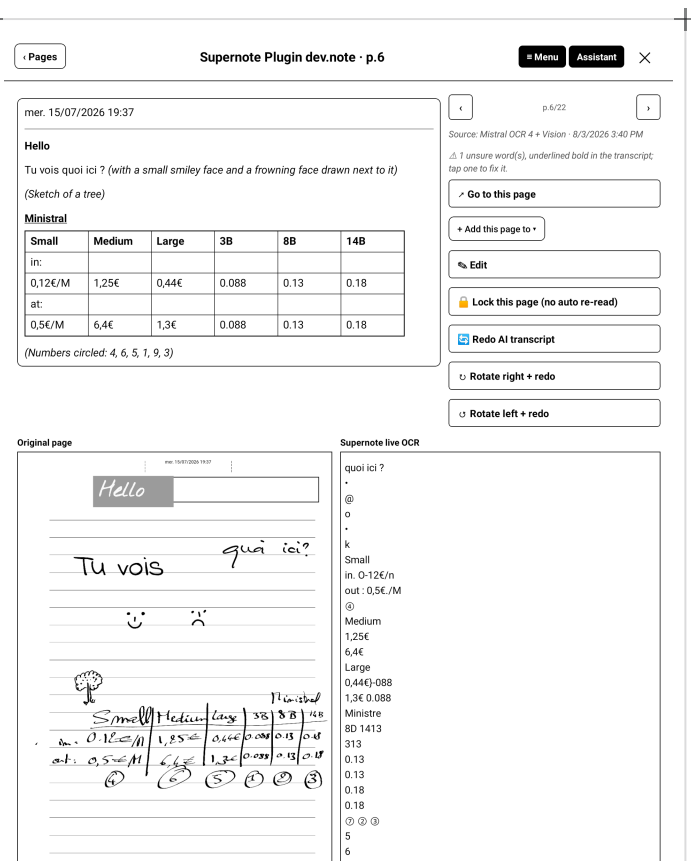


Fig. 4.4, One page, three views.

Open a document to see every page as a tile: the first lines of its transcript, its source, or *not read yet*. A page read and found empty says (*blank page*), it is done, not pending. Open a page and you get three things side by side: the transcript, the original page image, and the Supernote's own live OCR (free, for comparison)[only for .note].

From here you can: **edit the transcript by hand** (you can lock it afterwards to avoid the page to be overwritten); tap an underlined “unsure” word to fix just that word; **Redo AI transcript** to re-read the page (a single unified OCR + Vision pass); **Rotate right + redo** or **Rotate left + redo** to re-read a page rotated 90° (rarely needed, landscape pages are usually straightened automatically); and **Export this page** or add it to the chat.

Lock a page or a document

A **lock** freezes a transcript you are happy with. Lock a single page from its page view, or a whole document from the page grid, whose chip then reads **Lock document (N p. locked)**; locked rows also show a **Lock** icon in the Library. A locked page is never re-read automatically, even if its ink changes later, so a page you have hand-corrected stays exactly as you left it. On a locked page the **Redo AI transcript** and **Rotate right / left + redo** buttons are greyed out and decline; the lock/unlock toggle and **Edit** stay available, so manual corrections are always allowed.

The lock survives sync and *Restore backup*, and it **blocks every Clear**: a locked document refuses its own *Clear*, and locked pages survive a document *Clear*, *Clear transcripts of Off notes* and *Clear ALL transcripts* alike. The confirmation message spells out what will be kept.

4.3 · Search

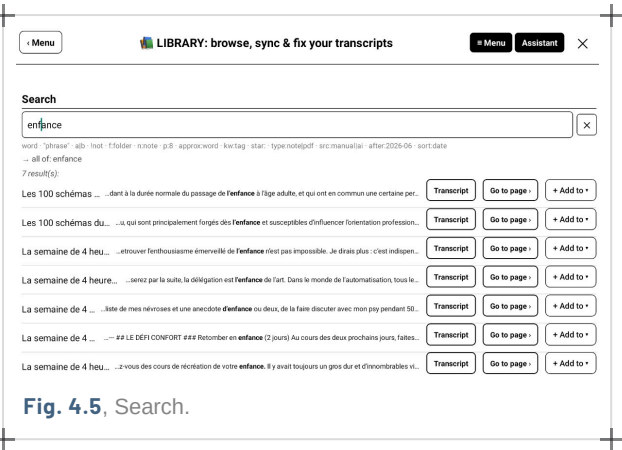


Fig. 4.5, Search.

Search runs over your local transcripts only, what has already been read. A document never synced is invisible until you sync it. Results are capped, and the line under the field always shows how your query was understood. On each result line you can open the transcript, *Go to page* (the Supernote opens the real page), or add the page to the chat. A document set to **Off** shows an *Off* chip instead of the add button: its pages are never sent to the AI.

Typing a bare word looks through your transcripts **and document names**: “bujo” finds BUJ0_T12S10 . pdf even if no page contains the word, the name match appears on top as “(document name)”. Prefixes still scope precisely: n : name only, f : folder, type : note | pdf, p : 8, star : , kw : ... The *Original page* preview of a PDF page shows your handwritten annotations composited on the printed page.

YOU TYPE	IT MEANS
budget review	both words, anywhere in the page (AND)
"quarterly review"	that exact phrase
budget forecast plan	any one of them (OR)
!draft · !"to do"	pages without that word / phrase
n:Egypt	in <u>n</u> otes whose name contains “Egypt”
f:Perso	in that <u>f</u> older
type:note · type:pdf	only notes, or only PDFs
star: · star:no	pages with / without a starred mark
kw:invoice	pages carrying that Supernote <u>keyword</u>
src>manual · src:ai	hand-corrected pages, or AI-read ones
after:2026-01 · before:2026-06	by read date
p:12 · p:first · p:last	page 12 (1-based) / first / last page
approx:meting	tolerate spelling variants
sort:date	order by date instead of relevance

Criteria combine freely: f:Work type:note "action items" !draft after:2026-03. Separators are a space or a +.

4.4 · Export

Transcripts become real files, **.md** (formatted) or **.txt** (plain), and you can start an export from every level:

FROM	EXPORTS
Library header · <i>Export all</i>	the whole library
a folder row · <i>Export ▼</i>	that folder and everything under it
a document row · <i>Export ▼</i>	that note or PDF
the page grid · <i>Select pages</i>	only the pages you ticked
a page view	that single page
a search result	the matching page

Files land in **/EXPORT/**, at the root of your Supernote, mirroring your folder tree. They're visible from a PC over USB, from the Supernote Partner app, and can be synced to the cloud. Each file starts with a header giving the date and how complete the export is. Re-export after a sync to refresh.

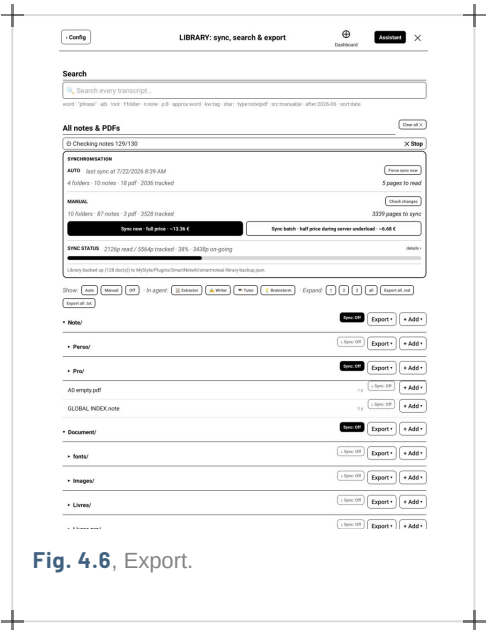


Fig. 4.6, Export.

5 The floating assistant

Open the assistant gives you a movable, resizable panel that floats over your note: you keep writing on the page while you talk about it.

Drag the header to move it, the black bar at the bottom to resize, the  button to collapse it into a floating bubble,  to snap it to a corner or full screen, and  to close it.

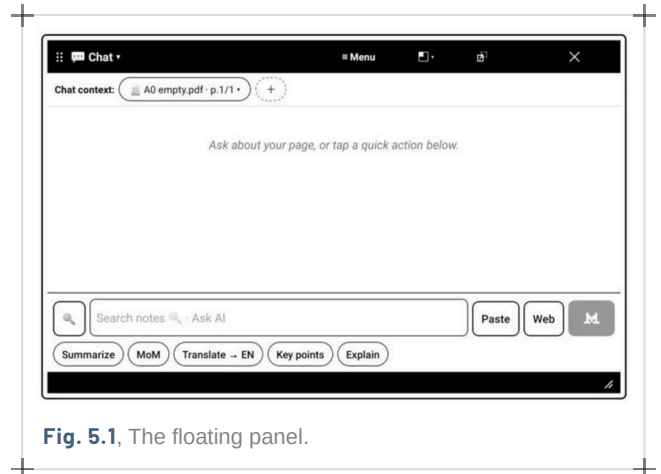


Fig. 5.1. The floating panel.

5.1 • CHAT

Chat answers come from your stored transcripts, instantly. A chat question never triggers a Vision pass: if the document changed since its last read, only the fast OCR runs so the answer has fresh text; the Vision quality catch-up happens in the background or on your next Sync, never behind a chat question. Asking about an unread document still asks for confirmation above 100 pages (OCR price only).

- The **brain dropdown** (name + arrow in the header) switches between CHAT and your agents. It shows the current model, how many documents and pages are loaded, *New chat*, and your *History*.
- **Quick actions** under the input write a prompt into the field; you send it yourself with the **M (Mistral logo)** button.
- **Web search** (one-shot button labeled **Web (non-EU)**, ≈0.01€ per search): arm it and it applies to your **NEXT** message only. Answers produced by a real web run carry a  **web · non-EU** badge and cite their sources. This is the plugin's one non-EU request (see Privacy): Mistral does not offer web search on EU inference.
- **No invented facts.** Without Web armed, the assistant is told, for every message, that it has no live data: it will not present remembered knowledge as current, and it never cites or fabricates source links. For time-sensitive questions (weather, news, prices) it asks you to arm Web. No  **web · non-EU** badge = the answer came from the model's memory.
- **Full transparency.** The exact system prompt a chat message sends (persona · agent documents · lasso directive · the per-message tool line) is shown in CHAT & AGENTS under “Full prompt, what the chat sends”, the same openness as the READ prompts in their own door.
- A **Stop** button is always available while the assistant works.
- Reading pages not read yet starts right away; only a large batch (**more than 100 pages ~0,4€**) asks you to confirm the price first. Below that, the read begins directly and its cost shows in the Library's MANUAL panel. Off files ask for a one-time consent, and their text is stored nowhere.
- Follow-up questions cost about **10% of the first**, thanks to prompt caching.

5.2 · Agents

Pick an agent from the brain dropdown when you start a conversation. It brings its persona, model, answer style, quick actions and its documents. You can also change agent mid-conversation to change the chat's behaviour, the full history is sent to the new model, so the discussion continues.

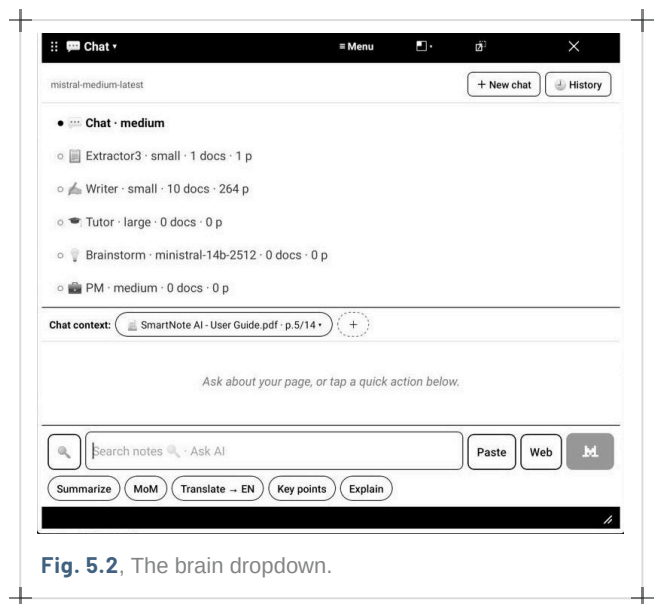


Fig. 5.2, The brain dropdown.

5.3 · Search from the panel

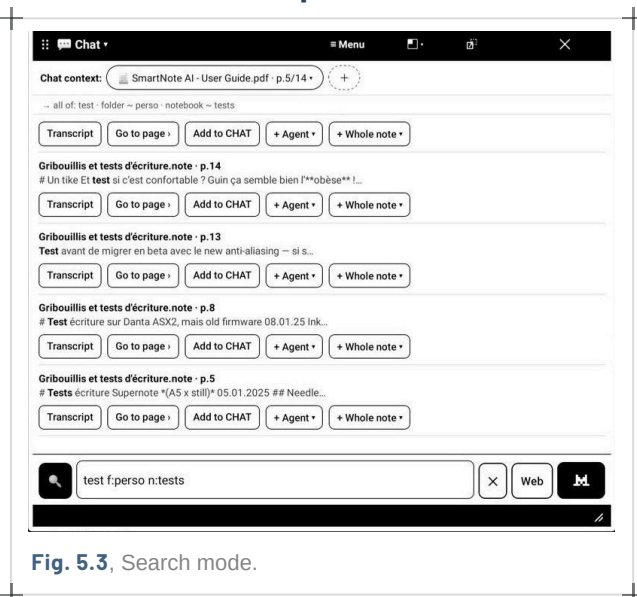


Fig. 5.3, Search mode.

The same search as the Library, without leaving your page. Tap the  **magnifier** to switch the panel into search mode (the placeholder changes to *Search notes*), and tap it again to go back to asking the AI. In search mode what you type is a query against your transcripts, nothing is sent anywhere. Each hit can be opened as a transcript, jumped to with *Go to page*, or added to the current conversation.

5.4 · Context management

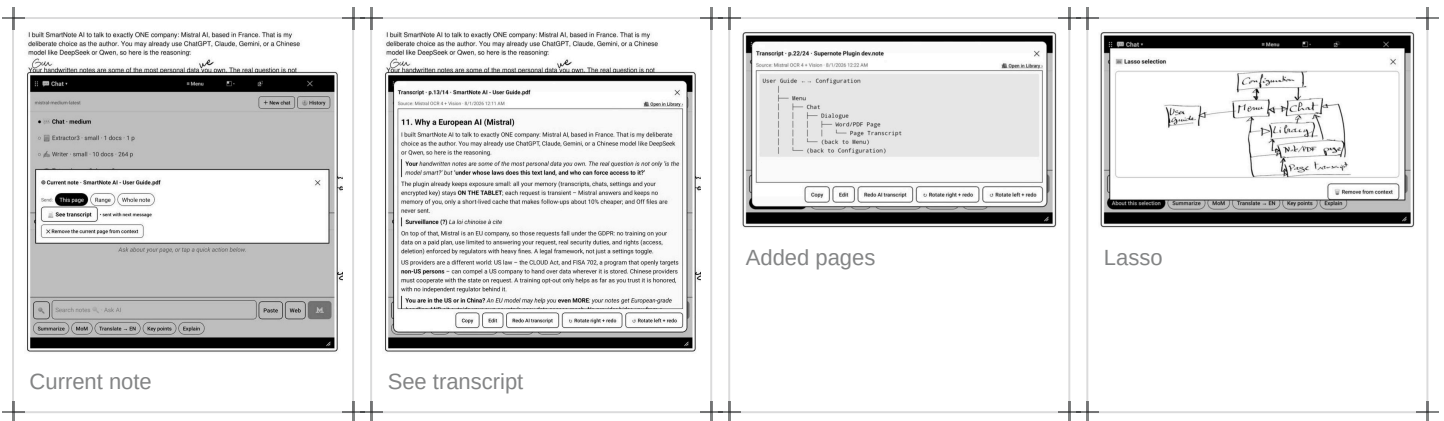
The **Chat context** row under the header shows exactly what will be sent. Each chip opens its own manager:

📄 **Current note**, choose the scope: This page, a Range, or the Whole note. *See transcript* shows this context only; you can also remove the current page.

📄 **Lasso**, the lassoed image itself, with *Remove from context*.

📄 **Added pages**, the pages you added from Library or Search, one per line, each with a ✕. *See transcript* shows them in order.

+, adds more pages from the Library. The current-page chip follows you as you turn pages.



5.5 · Lasso

Select part of a page with the Supernote lasso and tap **Ask SmartNote AI**. The selection is attached to the conversation as an image, it rides on whatever chat or agent is active. The image stays as a **Lasso chip** until you remove it (add several if you want). The instruction sent with it is the *Lasso: image reading* directive (Door 2), editable or empty. Your lasso quick actions (Door 3) appear while an image is in context. No transcription is involved: lasso a diagram and ask “explain this”, lasso a to-do and ask “turn this into a checklist”.

6 Extra

6.1 · Costs, privacy, tips

COSTS

- You pay Mistral directly, for what you read or ask.
- Transcription ~3.85€ / 1000 pages (EU regional pricing included, July 2026). Unchanged pages are never paid twice.
- A price dialog asks you to confirm only for a large read (**more than 100 pages**); smaller reads start directly, their cost shown in the Library's MANUAL panel. Auto reads silently. Set a monthly budget cap in the Mistral console for a hard ceiling.
- Chat is billed per token; follow-ups ~10% of the first thanks to caching.
- *Restore backup* merges by page identity: a more recent local page wins over the backup, and the restore reports any unreadable documents and skipped pages.
- Live usage: admin.mistral.ai/organization/usage

PRIVACY

- Off files never leave the device (one-time consent excepted, never stored).
- Transcripts, conversations, settings and your key live in the plugin's private directory, not cloud-synced, not visible over USB.
- **Mistral AI only, EU inference:** a European company (GDPR), and since v1.0.43 every request runs on Mistral's **EU regional endpoint**, your pages are processed in Europe by contract, not by assumption, protected from the US Cloud Act and the Chinese Data Security Law. EU regional pricing (+10% on Mistral's list prices) is already included in every estimate the plugin shows. On a paid API plan, your requests are never used to train Mistral's models. The ONE deliberate exception: the chat's optional **Web search**, Mistral does not offer web search on regional inference (a web query leaves the region by nature), so that single request uses their global endpoint, without a residency guarantee. Its button is labeled **Web (non-EU)** so the trade-off is always visible; everything else never leaves the EU endpoint.
- Still: do not put in any cloud what you would not want to leave the device at all. That is what Off is for.

TIPS

- Feed the glossary with your recurring names and jargon, accuracy jumps.
- Accuracy depends on your handwriting; the glossary is your lever.
- Something went wrong? Export a diagnostic log from Door 1 (see §3.2, Export Log) and attach it to a bug report.
- Only Supernote notes (.note) and PDFs are read; Word documents and other formats are not handled.
- Active notebooks on Auto, archives on Manual, private ones on Off.
- This guide lives in Document/SmartNote AI/. Deleting it is fine, the config home reinstalls it.
- Tested on the Manta and the A5 X. A firmware update can briefly break a plugin; check for a new release if something stops working right after one.

BEFORE UNINSTALLING, READ THIS

Uninstalling deletes the plugin's private directory, transcripts, conversations, settings and your stored key go with it. To keep them: **Library** → **Back up library**, and **Door 1** → **Export settings**. Both write to MyStyle/, which survives the uninstall and is visible over USB or in the Partner app.

6.2 · Why Mistral only

Why Mistral, and why Mistral only? That is a deliberate choice, here is the reasoning.

Our handwritten notes are usually very personal data, and privacy was my key concern throughout this plugin's development. The question is not only “is the model smart?” but “**under whose laws does this text land, and who can compel access to it?**”

The plugin already keeps exposure small: everything stays on the tablet, each request is transient (no memory beyond a short-lived cache), and Off files are never sent. But the biggest privacy factor is the choice of AI provider.

Mistral · EU (France)

Under EU law (GDPR), Mistral must limit use of your data to answering your request, secure it, and never train on it (paid plan). You keep enforceable rights, access and deletion, backed by regulators and heavy fines. Protection by law, not by a toggle. Data is processed on EU servers, under EU jurisdiction, so no foreign authority can quietly compel access. GDPR also demands transparency about what is kept and for how long, and any breach must be reported. It is a framework already tested by regulators, not a promise on a marketing page.

Other jurisdictions

In the US, the CLOUD Act lets authorities compel a US company to hand over data wherever it is stored, and FISA §702 targets surveillance of non-US persons abroad. In China, the National Intelligence Law (Art. 7) and the Data Security Law require companies to cooperate with the state on request. A training opt-out only helps as far as you trust it is honoured. And these powers reach data held abroad: where the servers sit matters less than which law the provider answers to. There is rarely notice to you, and little practical recourse from outside that country. That is the gap a European provider is meant to close.

You are in the US or China? An EU model may help you too: your notes get European-grade handling and sit outside your own country's easiest reach. No provider hides you from a determined state, and nothing dangerous should go into any cloud, but for everyday notes, moving them under EU law is a real privacy gain wherever you live.

Is the quality there? For reading handwritten notes or PDFs and chatting about them, no need for the latest state-of-the-art, overly expensive model. Mistral's OCR4 and Ministral vision models are very strong on reading (chosen on measured results), while Mistral Small, Medium and Large are also very good for discussion, summary, content understanding, basic calculation and everyday tasks. Important for good results: clear prompts, readable handwriting and your own glossary well filled in (see configuration door 2).

Top providers are clearly ahead in raw capability, but I am convinced that Mistral is “good enough” for Supernote user needs, and that trade-off is made on purpose, driven by **privacy first**.

6.3 · Licence

SmartNote AI is released under the **GNU Affero General Public License, version 3 (AGPL-3.0)**. In plain terms:

- You may read, audit, run, modify and share the code. Pull requests are welcome.
- If you distribute a modified version, or run one as a network service, you must publish your source under the same licence. Improvements come back to everyone.
- There is no warranty. You run it at your own risk.
- The name and logo are not covered by the licence: “SmartNote AI” and its icon stay mine, a fork must ship under its own name.

Why AGPL: the code is open for anyone to inspect, which matters for a plugin that handles your notes and claims to protect your privacy, but nobody can take the work, swap a few pieces, and close it up as their own product. The full licence text ships with the sources (LICENSE).

Sources, issues & pull requests

github.com/AgP42/SN-Plugin-SmartNoteAI

Support the project, ko-fi.com/agp42

